NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 1 • 1558–1569

Queen, Government and Religion, 1558–69



HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD: Queen Elizabeth I in Coronation Robes (c. 1600) NPG 2607 • NATIONAL PORTRAIT GALLERY • LONDON

Key topic 1: Queen, government and religion, 1558–69	
1 The situation on Elizabeth's accession	• Elizabethan England in 1558: society and government. • The Virgin Queen: the problem of her legitimacy, gender, marriage. Her character and strengths. • Challenges at home and from abroad: financial weaknesses, religious divisions, the French threat.
2 The 'settlement' of religion	• Elizabeth's religious settlement (1559): its features and impact. • The Church of England: its role in society.
3 Challenge to the religious settlement	• The nature and extent of the Puritan challenge. • The nature and extent of the Catholic challenge, including the role of the nobility, Papacy and foreign powers.
4 The problem of Mary, Queen of Scots	• Mary, Queen of Scots: her claim to the English throne. • Relations between Elizabeth and Mary, 1568–69.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 1)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

17 NOV 1558 • Accession of Elizabeth I & Council Appointments

Key Topic 1.1

Mary I dies; 25-year-old Elizabeth succeeds to the throne. She immediately appoints trusted Protestant statesman Sir William Cecil as her Principal Secretary, confronting £300,000 in Crown debts and French military forces stationed in Scotland.

MAY 1559 • The Acts of Supremacy & Uniformity (The Settlement)

Key Topic 1.2

Parliament passes the Religious Settlement. The Act of Supremacy establishes Elizabeth as 'Supreme Governor' of the Church of England; the Act of Uniformity mandates the 1559 Book of Common Prayer and imposes a 1 shilling fine for recusancy.

SUMMER 1559 • The Royal Injunctions & National Visitations

Key Topic 1.2

The Crown issues 57 Royal Injunctions enforcing Protestant worship. Clergy must preach royal supremacy, condemn papal authority, report recusants, and use English bibles. National visitations by 125 commissioners inspect parish compliance.

"Remember: Mary I left Elizabeth £300,000 of debt; don't leave blank lines in your exam!"

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 1)

Instructions: Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

JULY 1560 • The Treaty of Edinburgh

Key Topic 1.1 / 1.4

French troops withdraw from Scotland after a rebellion by Protestant Scottish lords. The Treaty establishes peace and Mary, Queen of Scots gives up her claim to the English throne, though Mary refuses to formally ratify the agreement.

1566 • The Vestments Controversy & Puritan Dissent

Key Topic 1.3

Archbishop Matthew Parker issues the 'Book of Advertisements' requiring all clergy to wear the surplice and tippet. In London, 37 Puritan vicars refuse to wear Catholic-style vestments and are deprived of their livings, revealing deep Protestant divisions.

MAY 1568 • Mary Queen of Scots Flees to England

Key Topic 1.4

Following the murder of Lord Darnley and defeat at Carberry Hill, Catholic Mary Stuart flees Scotland in a fishing boat to Workington, Cumberland. Elizabeth places her under armed house arrest, triggering twenty years of Catholic conspiracy.

How dangerous was the crisis facing Elizabeth I upon her accession in 1558?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • 5 CAUSAL MILESTONES

PUPIL NOTE-TAKING ZONE • *Answer each milestone prompt using evidence from teacher exposition*

1 17 NOV 1558
Accession of Elizabeth I
- £300,000 Crown Debt
- Antwerp Loans (14% Interest)
- Cecil Appointed Principal Secretary

Why did inherited debt and foreign loans create an immediate crisis for the new Queen?

2 NOV–DEC 1558
Features of Elizabethan Government
- 19-Man Privy Council
- Monopolies & Royal Licences
- Factional Balance at Court

How did Elizabeth use patronage and factional competition to secure political control?

3 DEC 1558
Challenges of Gender & Legitimacy
- Papal Rejection of Anne Boleyn
- 1536 Succession Act Bar
- Pressure to Produce Protestant Heir

Why did challenges to Elizabeth's gender and legitimacy threaten domestic stability?

4 JAN–MAY 1559
Parliament & Local Government
- Unpaid Justices of the Peace
- Lords Lieutenant County Militias
- Taxation Granted Solely by MPs

Why was Elizabeth entirely dependent on unpaid local gentry to enforce royal authority?

5 1558–1560
Foreign Threats: France & Scotland
- Loss of Calais (January 1558)
- Mary of Guise French Troops
- Quartered English Royal Arms

Why did the Auld Alliance and the loss of Calais make England vulnerable to foreign invasion?

"Patronage: Elizabeth gave out titles and monopolies, not marks; write the detail!"

Question 1 Practice: Describe Three Key Features [3 × 2 marks • 9 mins]

Total Score: [/ 6]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

★ HIGH PROBABILITY (Not examined in 7 years)

Edexcel June 2018 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the role of the Privy Council in 1558.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

CORE SPECIFICATION FOCUS

Edexcel June 2022 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of the financial weaknesses Elizabeth faced in 1558.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(C): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

HIGH-YIELD SPECIFICATION FOCUS

Edexcel Specification Focus

Describe one key feature of the challenges Elizabeth faced regarding marriage in 1558.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 1). In Milestone 1, sketch the Tudor Rose crown and note Elizabeth's £300,000 inherited debt.

← Pages 2–3

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins] EDEXCEL JUNE 2018 (Q2) ★ HIGH-YIELD FORECAST Score: [/ 12]

Explain why Elizabeth's legitimacy was questioned when she became queen in 1558.

You may use in your answer: • Her parents' marriage • Mary, Queen of Scots *(You must also use information of your own.)*

1. CAUSE 1: ANNE BOLEYN & PAPAL LAW — POINT 1	2. CAUSE 2: HENRY VIII'S OWN SUCCESSION ACTS — POINT 2	3. CAUSE 3: CATHOLIC MARY, QUEEN OF SCOTS — POINT 3
Explain that Catholics never recognized Henry VIII's divorce from Catherine of Aragon; the Pope declared his marriage to Anne Boleyn illegal, rendering Elizabeth an illegitimate bastard.	Explain that after Anne Boleyn was beheaded in 1536, Parliament passed the 1536 Succession Act declaring Elizabeth illegitimate, creating enduring legal doubt despite the 1544 Act.	Explain that strict Catholics viewed Mary Stuart, granddaughter of Henry VIII's sister Margaret Tudor, as the legitimate, Catholic, God-ordained rightful heir to the English throne.

Task: *Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):*

"Extended writing: develop your 3-paragraph structure with precise evidence on every line."

MARGIN	*[Extended Writing Continued • Paragraph 2/3 & Final Sustained Conclusion]*

Was Elizabeth's Religious Settlement a brilliant compromise or an unstable truce?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • 5 CAUSAL MILESTONES

PUPIL NOTE-TAKING ZONE • *Answer each milestone prompt using evidence from teacher exposition*

1 NOV 1558–JAN 1559

Religious Divisions in 1558

- Conservative North & Western Gentry
- Radical Returning Marian Exiles
- Marian Bishops in Lords

Why did England's geographic and political divisions make a religious settlement essential?

2 MAY 1559

The Act of Supremacy

- 'Supreme Governor' Compromise Title
- Compulsory Oath for Clergy
- All Marian Bishops Deprived

Why did Elizabeth choose the title 'Supreme Governor' instead of 'Supreme Head'?

3 MAY 1559

The Act of Uniformity

- Compulsory 1559 Prayer Book
- One-Shilling Recusancy Fine
- Deliberate Communion Ambiguity

How did the Act of Uniformity attempt to compromise between Catholic and Protestant worship?

4 SUMMER 1559

The Royal Injunctions

- Fifty-Seven Royal Directives
- English Bible in Every Church
- Pilgrimages & Fake Miracles Banned

How did the Royal Injunctions establish central royal control over local parish life?

5 1559–1560s

Enforcing the Settlement & Church Role

- 125 Visitation Commissioners
- Parish Church Court Supervision
- Four Hundred Clergy Resignations

How effectively did royal visitations and Church courts enforce conformity across England?

"The Middle Way was a compromise: Protestants got English Bibles, Catholics kept vestments."

Question 1 Practice: Describe Three Key Features [3 × 2 marks • 9 mins]

Total Score: [/ 6]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS] ★ HIGH PROBABILITY

Edexcel SAMs (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the Act of Supremacy (1559).

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS] RECENT EXAM BOARD FOCUS

Edexcel June 2023 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the Royal Injunctions of 1559.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(C): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

HIGH-YIELD SPECIFICATION FOCUS

Edexcel Specification Focus

Describe one key feature of the Act of Uniformity (1559).

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 2). In Milestone 2, sketch the open English Book of Common Prayer and note the 1 shilling recusancy fine.

← Pages 2–3

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 SPaG • 25 mins]

EDEXCEL SAMS (Q3) | ★ HIGH-YIELD FORECAST | Score: [/ 20]

'Elizabeth's religious settlement of 1559 was completely successful in pleasing all religious groups.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

You may use in your answer: • The Act of Uniformity (1559) • The Puritan challenge *(You must also use information of your own.)*

1. CRITERIA 1: SUCCESSFUL VIA MEDIA — POINT 1	2. CRITERIA 2: PURITAN DISCONTENT — POINT 2	3. CRITERIA 3: CATHOLIC ALIENATION — POINT 3
Explain how the Settlement successfully achieved a broad Middle Way: moderate Protestant theology (English services, Book of Common Prayer) combined with Catholic outward ritual (vestments, candles) to prevent civil war.	Explain that the Settlement failed to satisfy zealous Puritans: they condemned the crucifix and vestments as "idolatrous popish rags" and challenged Elizabeth's authority in the 1566 Vestments Controversy.	Explain that devout Catholics could not accept Elizabeth as Supreme Governor; almost all Catholic bishops resigned in 1559, recusancy grew in the North, and the Pope later excommunicated Elizabeth in 1570.

Task: *Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):*

"Recusancy fines: 1 shilling was a week's wage for a labourer; factual depth secures Grade 9."

MARGIN	*[Extended Writing Continued • Paragraph 2/3 & Final Sustained Conclusion]*

Which group posed the greater danger to Elizabeth: zealous Puritans or defiant Catholics?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • 5 CAUSAL MILESTONES

PUPIL NOTE-TAKING ZONE • *Answer each milestone prompt using evidence from teacher exposition*

1 **1559–1563**

The Nature of the Puritan Challenge

- Geneva Calvinist Influence
- Demand to Abolish Holy Days
- Threat to Royal Prerogative

Why did Puritan religious demands pose a direct challenge to Elizabeth's royal authority?

2 **1566**

The Crucifix & Vestments Controversy

- Parker's Book of Advertisements
- White Linen Surplice Requirement
- Thirty-Seven London Priests Sacked

Why did the dispute over clergy vestments become a major test of Elizabeth's control?

3 **1559–1568**

The Catholic Challenge at Home

- Church Papists Attending Services
- Lax Local JPs in North
- Tolerant 'Windows Into Men's Souls'

Why was Elizabeth able to tolerate moderate Catholic non-conformity during the early 1560s?

4 **1562–1568**

Foreign Threats: France & The Netherlands

- French Wars of Religion (1562)
- 10,000 Spanish Troops under Alba
- Council of Troubles Brutality

Why did the arrival of Alba's Spanish army in the Netherlands alarm the English Privy Council?

5 **1568–1569**

Escalating Tensions: The Genoese Loan

- £85,000 Italian Bullion Storm Shelter
- Queen Claims Italian Bank Loan
- Alba Imposes English Trade Embargo

How did the seizure of the Genoese Loan push England and Spain closer to open conflict?

"Puritans hated crucifixes and vestments; examiners hate vague assertions."

Question 1 Practice: Describe Three Key Features [3 × 2 marks • 9 mins]

Total Score: [/ 6]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

MEDIUM FREQUENCY | Edexcel November 2020 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the Vestments Controversy (1566).

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

RECENT EXAM BOARD FOCUS | Edexcel June 2024 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of recusancy in early Elizabethan England.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(C): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

HIGH-YIELD SPECIFICATION FOCUS | Edexcel Specification Focus

Describe one key feature of the Puritan challenge over crucifixes.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 5). In Milestone 5, sketch the plain Puritan surplice and the crossed-out Catholic crucifix.

← Pages 2–3

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins] EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 (Q2) ★ HIGH-YIELD FORECAST Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the Puritans challenged Elizabeth's religious settlement between 1559 and 1566.

You may use in your answer: • Vestments • The Crucifix Controversy *(You must also use information of your own.)*

1. CAUSE 1: VESTMENTS & POPISH RAGS — POINT 1	2. CAUSE 2: CRUCIFIXES & GRAVEN IMAGES — POINT 2	3. CAUSE 3: BISHOPS & LITURGICAL PURITY — POINT 3
Explain that Puritans, influenced by Genevan Calvinism, viewed priestly vestments (surplices) as unscriptural Catholic idolatry that set clergy apart from ordinary congregations.	Explain that Puritans believed crucifixes violated the Ten Commandments against graven images; several Puritan bishops threatened to resign when Elizabeth insisted on a crucifix in her chapel.	Explain that Puritans wanted to eradicate the hierarchy of bishops and eradicate holy days, organs, and kneeling at communion, aiming for an entirely purified biblical church.

Task: *Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):*

"Disciplinary notes: evaluate Puritan frustration against the Queen's demand for uniform order."

MARGIN	*[Extended Writing Continued • Paragraph 2/3 & Final Sustained Conclusion]*

Was Mary, Queen of Scots an innocent royal refugee or an existential threat to the realm?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • 5 CAUSAL MILESTONES

PUPIL NOTE-TAKING ZONE • *Answer each milestone prompt using evidence from teacher exposition*

1 1560–1565

Mary's Claim to the English Throne

- Margaret Tudor Granddaughter Lineage
- Marriage to Henry Lord Darnley
- Legitimate Catholic Figurehead

Why did Mary Stuart's royal ancestry and marriage choices threaten Elizabeth's security?

2 FEB 1567

The Murder of Lord Darnley

- Kirk o' Field Gunpowder Explosion
- Marriage to Earl of Bothwell
- Scottish Protestant Rebellion

Why did Darnley's murder and Mary's marriage to Bothwell ruin her authority in Scotland?

3 1567–1568

Abdication, Lochleven & Escape

- Forced Abdication for Infant James VI
- Fishing Boat Crossing to Workington
- Anointed Monarch Under House Arrest

Why did Mary's unexpected arrival in England present Elizabeth with an impossible dilemma?

4 1568–1569

The Inquiry at York & Casket Letters

- Eight French Casket Love Letters
- Refusal of Direct Cross-Examination
- No Verdict Justifies Detention

Why did Elizabeth choose an inconclusive verdict rather than declaring Mary guilty or innocent?

5 1569

Mary's Imprisonment in England

- Guarded by Earl of Shrewsbury
- Duke of Norfolk Court Marriage Plot
- Magnet for Northern Catholic Discontent

Why did Mary Stuart's presence in England inevitably lead to armed Catholic rebellion?

"Mary, Queen of Scots arrived in 1568 in a fishing boat; don't let your essay drift."

Question 1 Practice: Describe Three Key Features [3 × 2 marks • 9 mins]

Total Score: [/ 6]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

MEDIUM FREQUENCY

Edexcel November 2021 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of Mary, Queen of Scots' claim to the English throne.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

★ HIGH PROBABILITY (Never examined)

★ High-Yield Forecast (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of the inquiry into the Casket Letters (1568–69).

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(C): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

HIGH-YIELD SPECIFICATION FOCUS

Edexcel Specification Focus

Describe one key feature of Mary, Queen of Scots' arrival in England in May 1568.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 6). In Milestone 6, sketch Carlisle Castle where Mary Stuart was first held under house arrest in 1568.

← Pages 2–3

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 SPaG • 25 mins]

EDEXCEL JUNE 2022 (Q3A) | **CORE SPECIFICATION FOCUS** | **Score: [/ 20]**

'The arrival of Mary, Queen of Scots in England in 1568 was the main cause of instability in Elizabethan government.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

You may use in your answer: • Mary's claim to the throne • Religious divisions in the North *(You must also use information of your own.)*

1. CRITERIA 1: MARY AS CATHOLIC FIGUREHEAD (POINT 1)	2. CRITERIA 2: PRE-EXISTING NORTHERN DISCONTENT (POINT 2)	3. CRITERIA 3: SUCCESSION & DIPLOMATIC RISK (POINT 3)
Explain how Mary's physical presence provided a live, legitimate Catholic alternative to Elizabeth, immediately attracting discontented northern nobles and foreign Catholic conspirators.	Explain that the North was already deeply Catholic and alienated by Cecil's centralizing Protestant government; the Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland had lost land and influence before 1568.	Explain that Elizabeth had no heir; Mary's presence forced foreign powers (France, Spain, Papacy) to view Elizabeth as expendable, turning Mary into a catalyst for domestic rebellion.

Task: *Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):*

MARGIN	*[Extended Writing Continued • Paragraph 2/3 & Final Sustained Conclusion]*

⭐ GRADE 9 MASTERCLASS: CAUSATION ESSAY • KEY TOPIC 1

EDEXCEL SPECIFICATION · PAPER 2 | **LEVEL 4 EXEMPLAR • 12/12 MARKS**

OFFICIAL EXAM QUESTION • QUESTION 2 [12 MARKS • 18 MINS] — AO1 (6m Knowledge & Understanding) + AO2 (6m Causation & Analysis)

Explain why Elizabeth faced challenges upon her accession in 1558.

You may use in your answer: • The French threat • Financial weaknesses *(You must also use information of your own.)*

ACTIVE MODEL ANNOTATION PROTOCOL: 🟠 1. Highlight 3 historical facts / statistics | 🔵 2. Underline 3 causal connective links | 🟢 3. Circle where own knowledge beyond stimulus begins

CONTINUOUS PROSE LEVEL 4 EXEMPLAR RESPONSE (FULL MARKS • 12/12)

Notice: Every paragraph opens with a factor, gives precise evidence, and ends with a direct causal link.

PARAGRAPH 1 • STIMULUS 1 A primary challenge Elizabeth faced upon her accession was the acute military and diplomatic threat from France. In 1558, England was militarily vulnerable following the disastrous loss of Calais in January—England's last continental possession—which severely damaged national prestige and removed the defensive buffer across the Channel. Compounding this, France was allied with Scotland via the "Auld Alliance", and Mary of Guise governed Scotland with French troops stationed directly along the English border. Furthermore, Mary, Queen of Scots had married the French Dauphin, Francis, and openly declared herself the rightful Queen of England, incorporating the English royal coat of arms into her own. This left Elizabeth immediately encircled by a hostile Catholic superpower capable of launching a two-pronged invasion.

PARAGRAPH 2 • STIMULUS 2 Furthermore, Elizabeth inherited crippling financial weaknesses from Mary I that threatened to paralyse the English state. In November 1558, Crown debt stood at an astronomical £300,000, while annual royal revenue was roughly £287,000, requiring £65,000 annually merely to service interest owed to foreign moneylenders in Antwerp. Consecutive Tudor monarchs had debased the silver coinage to fund wars in France, resulting in rampant price inflation, devastating ordinary households and ruining England's international credit rating. Because Elizabeth needed extraordinary taxation from Parliament to function, her financial desperation risked forcing her into humiliating political concessions before her government was securely established.

PARAGRAPH 3 • OWN KNOWLEDGE Beyond the stimulus, Elizabeth's authority was fundamentally undermined by the dual dilemmas of her gender and legitimacy. In sixteenth-century Europe, society firmly believed female monarchy was "unnatural" and inherently weak, assuming a queen regnant could not lead armies or govern effectively without male control. Aggravating this prejudice was the question of Elizabeth's dynastic legitimacy. Roman Catholics throughout England and Europe regarded Henry VIII's marriage to Anne Boleyn as invalid because the Pope had never sanctioned Henry's divorce from Catherine of Aragon. Under Catholic canon law, Elizabeth was illegitimate, meaning she had no legal right to inherit the crown. This dynastic vulnerability encouraged both domestic Catholic dissidents and foreign monarchs to view her regime as illegitimate and vulnerable to overthrow.

EXAMINER COMPARISON • WHY MOST PUPILS DROP MARKS ON QUESTION 2

⚠️ **The Level 2 Narrative Trap (4–6 / 12 Marks):**
Pupils describe Tudor problems as a factual list: "First England was £300,000 in debt. Next the French were in Scotland. Also people thought women should not rule, and Catholics disliked Anne Boleyn." This narrates what the problems were rather than explaining WHY they constituted grave threats to state security, financial stability, and monarchical survival.

🎯 **The Level 4 Analytical Standard (10–12 / 12 Marks):**
Every paragraph explains the specific mechanism of danger tied directly to the question stem (encirclement and invasion risk from France; sovereign insolvency and dependence on Parliament; ideological rebellion sparked by illegitimacy and gender). Integrates precise quantitative evidence (£300,000 debt, £65,000 interest, loss of Calais, Mary of Guise) and substantial own knowledge beyond the stimulus.

✍️ **PUPIL ACTION • DRAFT YOUR OWN ANALYTICAL CONCLUSION [2 SENTENCES]**

State which challenge posed the greatest immediate threat to Elizabeth in 1558 (foreign French invasion, Crown insolvency, or questions over her legitimacy) and justify your choice in 2 sentences:

"Visualise the structure: Monarch rules, Privy Council advises, Parliament taxes, JPs enforce."

UNSEEN SYNOPTIC EXAM PRACTICE • KEY TOPIC 1

PEARSON EDEXCEL NOV 2020 · PAPER 2 | **Timed Condition: 18 Mins** | **Score: [/ 12]**

QUESTION 2 • EXPLAIN WHY [12 MARKS • AO1 (6M) + AO2 (6M)] — Write 3 analytical paragraphs with sustained causal links to the stem

Explain why Elizabeth faced serious opposition to her religious settlement in the years 1559–69.

You may use in your answer: • The Vestments Controversy (1566) • Papal Bull / Recusancy *(You must also use information of your own.)*

PARAGRAPH 1 (STIMULUS 1) PLAN

Factor 1 · Puritan Resistance: Archbishop Parker's Book of Advertisements (1566) required clerical surplices; 37 London vicars refused and were suspended; challenged royal supremacy.

PARAGRAPH 2 (STIMULUS 2) PLAN

Factor 2 · Catholic Recusancy: Devout Catholic gentry refused Protestant services; paid 1s fines; Pope Pius IV forbade church attendance; secret household Latin Masses.

PARAGRAPH 3 (OWN KNOWLEDGE) CRUCIAL

Factor 3 · Own Knowledge (Crucial): Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569); Catholic Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland marched on Durham Cathedral, restored Latin Mass, and aimed to free Mary Stuart.

MARGIN	*[Begin your 3-paragraph timed causation response here...]*

Level Descriptors:	[ ] L1 (1–3m): Basic / Descriptive	[ ] L2 (4–6m): Simple Explanation	[ ] L3 (7–9m): Developed Analysis	[ ] L4 (10–12m): Sustained Causal Judgement	**Final Mark: [/ 12]**

"Via Media: Neither Geneva nor Rome, but an English compromise designed to avoid civil war."

Cumulative Specification Recall: Enquiries 1.1 & 1.2

Classroom Protocol: Complete 5–10 questions as a Do Now bell-ringer at the start of each lesson, or quiz yourself across the term. Tick the review checkboxes (**R1, R2, R3**) after each spaced retrieval attempt.

ENQUIRY 1.1: THE SITUATION ON ELIZABETH'S ACCESSION, 1558

[/ 10]

1. Which Tudor monarch was Elizabeth I's father? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

2. Who was Elizabeth I's mother, executed in 1536? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

3. Which Catholic queen preceded Elizabeth on the throne (1553–58)? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

4. What religion was Queen Elizabeth I? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

5. What ancient English possession in France was lost in January 1558? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

6. Approximately how much Crown debt did Elizabeth inherit in 1558? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

7. Who did Elizabeth appoint as her trusted Principal Secretary in 1558? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

8. Which institution had the sole legal power to grant monarchical taxes? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

9. Which unpaid local officials maintained law and order in counties? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

10. Which northern kingdom was ruled by Mary of Guise in 1558? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

ENQUIRY 1.2: THE 'SETTLEMENT' OF RELIGION, 1559

[/ 10]

11. What title did Henry VIII claim over the Church of England in 1534? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

12. What language was the Catholic Latin Mass spoken in? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

13. What term describes Protestants who wanted to purify the Church of all Catholic practices? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

14. What was the official fine for refusing to attend church under the 1559 Act of Uniformity? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

15. What title did Elizabeth I adopt under the 1559 Act of Supremacy? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

16. What English prayer book was made compulsory in all parish churches in 1559? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

17. What official set of 57 instructions enforced the 1559 Settlement? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

18. What was a Catholic called who refused to attend Anglican church services? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

19. How many Marian Catholic bishops refused the Oath of Supremacy in 1559? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

20. Who was appointed Elizabeth's first Protestant Archbishop of Canterbury in 1559? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

"Grade 9 Rule: Q1 requires Feature + Detail. Name the feature, then drop the factual hammer."

Cumulative Specification Recall: Enquiries 1.3 & 1.4

Spaced Retention Target: Test yourself on previous weeks' topics before starting a new enquiry. Frequent low-stakes retrieval prevents forgetting and secures Level 4 factual precision.

ENQUIRY 1.3: CHALLENGE TO THE RELIGIOUS SETTLEMENT [/ 10]

21. What Latin term means "the middle way", describing Elizabeth's settlement? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

22. Which white linen robe did Puritans refuse to wear during church services? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

23. Which Archbishop of Canterbury issued the 1566 Book of Advertisements? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

24. How many London priests were dismissed in 1566 for refusing to wear vestments? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

25. What object did Elizabeth place in the Royal Chapel that outraged Puritans? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

26. What Catholic movement aimed to stamp out Protestantism across Europe? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

27. Which Catholic king ruled Spain, the Netherlands, and the Spanish Empire? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

28. What region of England was most heavily Catholic in the 1560s? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

29. What council of Catholic clergy (1545–63) reaffirmed Catholic doctrines? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

30. Did King Philip II of Spain immediately attack Elizabeth in 1559? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

ENQUIRY 1.4: THE PROBLEM OF MARY, QUEEN OF SCOTS [/ 10]

31. Who was Mary, Queen of Scots' first husband, King of France? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

32. Which grandmother gave Mary Stuart a legitimate claim to the English throne? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

33. What religion was Mary, Queen of Scots? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

34. Who was Mary's second husband, found strangled after Kirk o'Field exploded in 1567? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

35. Whom did Mary marry shortly after Darnley's suspicious death? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

36. In what year did Mary Stuart flee across the border into England? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

37. In what northern castle was Mary first held under armed house arrest? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

38. What alleged love letters were presented to prove Mary murdered Darnley? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

39. Did Elizabeth formally find Mary guilty of murder at the York Inquiry in 1568–69? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

40. Which powerful Catholic noble family in France was Mary closely related to? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

🔁 **QUICK-CHECK ANSWER KEY • KEY TOPIC 1 SYNOPTIC VAULT (QUESTIONS 1–40)**

Enquiry 1.1 (Q1–10): **1.** King Henry VIII • **2.** Anne Boleyn • **3.** Mary I (Mary Tudor) • **4.** Protestant • **5.** Calais • **6.** £300,000 • **7.** Sir William Cecil (Lord Burghley) • **8.** Parliament • **9.** Justices of the Peace (JPs) • **10.** Scotland

Enquiry 1.2 (Q11–20): **11.** Supreme Head of the Church of England • **12.** Latin • **13.** Puritans • **14.** One shilling (12 pence) • **15.** Supreme Governor of the Church of England • **16.** The Book of Common Prayer • **17.** The Royal Injunctions • **18.** A Recusant • **19.** All except one (27 out of 28 bishops) • **20.** Matthew Parker

Enquiry 1.3 (Q21–30): **21.** Via Media • **22.** The Surplice • **23.** Matthew Parker • **24.** 37 priests • **25.** A silver Crucifix • **26.** The Counter-Reformation • **27.** King Philip II of Spain • **28.** The North of England (Lancashire, Yorkshire, Durham) • **29.** The Council of Trent • **30.** No (he hoped Elizabeth might marry him or ally with Spain against France)

Enquiry 1.4 (Q31–40): **31.** King Francis II • **32.** Margaret Tudor (sister of Henry VIII) • **33.** Roman Catholic • **34.** Lord Darnley • **35.** The Earl of Bothwell • **36.** 1568 • **37.** Carlisle Castle (later Bolton Castle) • **38.** The Casket Letters • **39.** No (Elizabeth gave a "not proven" verdict to avoid executing a sovereign monarch) • **40.** The Guise family (House of Guise)

Rotate booklet 180° to self-mark retrieval drills in green pen

"Timed Condition Challenge: 12 marks means 3 paragraphs with 3 distinct causal links."

23/24

THE HISTORY DEPARTMENT • ASSESSMENT & PROGRESS RECORD

KEY TOPIC 1 ASSESSMENT & HOMEWORK RECORD

PUPIL: _____ **TARGET GRADE:** [ ] **PREDICTED:** [ ] **ATTITUDE:** 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5

MASTER EXAM PRACTICE & HOMEWORK ASSESSMENT TRACKER • KEY TOPIC 1

#	ENQUIRY & SPECIFICATION TOPIC	PAGE	EXAM PRACTICE QUESTION & FOCUS	HOMEWORK DEADLINE	MARK AWARDED
1.1	ENQUIRY 1.1: THE SITUATION ON ELIZABETH'S ACCESSION, 1558 Do Now Retrieval (p. 4): [/ 10]	p. 5	**Q1(a) Feature:** the role of the Privy Council in 1558 [2m]	[___/___]	[/ 2]
		p. 5	**Q1(b) Feature:** the financial weaknesses Elizabeth faced in 1558 [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 5	**Q1(c) Feature:** the challenges Elizabeth faced regarding marriage in 1558 [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 5	**Q2 Explain Why:** Explain why Elizabeth's legitimacy was questioned when she became q... [12m]		[/ 12]
1.2	ENQUIRY 1.2: THE 'SETTLEMENT' OF RELIGION, 1559 Do Now Retrieval (p. 8): [/ 10]	p. 9	**Q1(a) Feature:** the Act of Supremacy (1559) [2m]	[___/___]	[/ 2]
		p. 9	**Q1(b) Feature:** the Royal Injunctions of 1559 [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 9	**Q1(c) Feature:** the Act of Uniformity (1559) [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 9	**Q3 Essay:** 'Elizabeth's religious settlement of 1559 was completely successful... [16m]		[/ 16]
1.3	ENQUIRY 1.3: CHALLENGE TO THE RELIGIOUS SETTLEMENT Do Now Retrieval (p. 12): [/ 10]	p. 13	**Q1(a) Feature:** the Vestments Controversy (1566) [2m]	[___/___]	[/ 2]
		p. 13	**Q1(b) Feature:** recusancy in early Elizabethan England [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 13	**Q1(c) Feature:** the Puritan challenge over crucifixes [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 13	**Q2 Explain Why:** Explain why the Puritans challenged Elizabeth's religious settlemen... [12m]		[/ 12]
1.4	ENQUIRY 1.4: THE PROBLEM OF MARY, QUEEN OF SCOTS Do Now Retrieval (p. 16): [/ 10]	p. 17	**Q1(a) Feature:** Mary, Queen of Scots' claim to the English throne [2m]	[___/___]	[/ 2]
		p. 17	**Q1(b) Feature:** the inquiry into the Casket Letters (1568–69) [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 17	**Q1(c) Feature:** Mary, Queen of Scots' arrival in England in May 1568 [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 17	**Q3 Essay:** 'The arrival of Mary, Queen of Scots in England in 1568 was the mai... [16m]		[/ 16]

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ENQUIRY 1.1
The situation on Elizabeth's acces...
Elizabethan government • Monarch, Pr...

LESSON — Read Online
20-Q QUIZ — Self-Marking

Quiz Attempt: [ ] 1st [ ] 2nd [ ] 3rd
Score: [/ 20] Date: ___/___

ENQUIRY 1.2
The 'settlement' of religion, 1559
The Act of Supremacy • 1559

LESSON — Read Online
20-Q QUIZ — Self-Marking

Quiz Attempt: [ ] 1st [ ] 2nd [ ] 3rd
Score: [/ 20] Date: ___/___

ENQUIRY 1.3
Challenge to the religious settlem...
The nature and extent of the Puritan chal...

LESSON — Read Online
20-Q QUIZ — Self-Marking

Quiz Attempt: [ ] 1st [ ] 2nd [ ] 3rd
Score: [/ 20] Date: ___/___

ENQUIRY 1.4
The problem of Mary, Queen of Sc...
Mary, Queen of Scots: her claim to the En...

LESSON — Read Online
20-Q QUIZ — Self-Marking

Quiz Attempt: [ ] 1st [ ] 2nd [ ] 3rd
Score: [/ 20] Date: ___/___